

THE ROCK CLIMBER'S TRAINING MANUAL

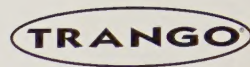
A Guide to Continuous Improvement



**BASED ON
THE PROVEN
ROCK PRODIGY
PROGRAM**



Michael L. Anderson PhD
Mark L. Anderson



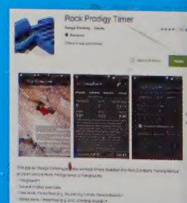
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THE ROCK CLIMBER'S TRAINING MANUAL

*A Guide to
Continuous Improvement*



BASED ON
THE PROVEN
ROCK PRODIGY
PROGRAM

Michael L. Anderson
Mark L. Anderson

The Rock Climber's Training Manual: A Guide to Continuous Improvement

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Opening page photo: Cody Roth getting lucky on *A Date With Death*, 5.13c, Sandias, NM. photo: Andrew Burr.

Table of Contents photo: Morgan Mcneil on *Cradle of the Deep Original*, 5.13a, Horseshoe Canyon, AR. photo: Cole Fennel.

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"With clear, concise, goal-oriented prose, inspiring full-color photographs, and all the charts you'll need to get rolling on your own Rock Prodigy program, the Anderson brothers have compiled and made imminently accessible their impressive body of training lore. With proven results in their own careers, the Andersons show you how to make the most of limited training time, to time your training cycles for redpoint optimization, and to systematically improve as a rock climber. If becoming a better and stronger, more consistently performing climber is your goal, then this is the book for you!"

— Matt Samet, 5.14 first ascensionist, former editor of *Climbing Magazine*
and author of *the Climbing Dictionary* and *The Crag Survival Handbook*

"The Andersons understand not only the strength and technique required in training, but also the mental dedication necessary to push one's limits. Their experience as top-level athletes in the field, rather than just trainers in the gym, directly validates *The Rock Climber's Training Manual*. Even seasoned climbing veterans can benefit from understanding the science behind their performance cycle, particularly when those words of wisdom come from climbers who have self-tested, re-tested, and fine-tuned their training methods for over fifteen years."

— Paige Claassen, US National Champion and 5.14 First Ascensionist

"This is the best climbing training book ever written. It is a complete guide to success in hard rock climbing, and is a must-read for anyone serious about the sport. I don't think there is a climber in the world that wouldn't benefit from reading and applying the Rock Prodigy program."

— Steve Bechtel, Certified Strength and Conditioning Specialist, climbstrong.com

"Training is central to achieving any athletic goal. It gives an outlet for our drive, and provides the strength and technical practice we need to improve. *The Rock Climber's Training Manual* clearly lays out the details of how to train effectively to take your climbing to the next level."

— Tommy Caldwell, First Free Ascensionist of four El Cap Big Wall Free Climbs

"Whether you're a beginner or a seasoned vet, a sport climber or big waller, the Anderson brothers have been there, done that. Their training secrets are all here, laid out in a solid blend of science and anecdotal evidence, ready for you to apply to your next project. If you're searching for the path to your next level, this is where you'll find it."

— Kris Hampton, Climbing Coach, powercompanyclimbing.com

"During my early climbing years I worked on my skill and technique, but still struggled when it came time to bare down. It wasn't until I started following the Rock Prodigy program that I experienced marked improvements and since then, I've improved roughly a letter grade every six months. No other training resource has benefited more climbers, and now the Andersons have expanded and updated those concepts into a must-read for those looking to improve their climbing ability."

— Ryan Palo, Dedicated Weekend Warrior and 5.14 First Ascensionist

"*The Rock Climber's Training Manual* is an exceptional book—just flipping through the pages gets me stoked to train. I specifically like the mix of scientific and physiological explanation alongside great photographs, diagrams and suggestions that make all the data applicable to your training and climbing. I'll definitely be referencing this book during my next training period."

— Jonathan Siegrist, Professional climber, 5.14d First Ascensionist

FOREWORD

I started climbing in 1986. I wasn't an athlete and could have been best described as a founding member of the video game generation. Slow, lazy, and heavy. In high school, I became interested in climbing through a previous interest in rappelling, which was fueled not by adventure or a love of the outdoors, but by the cool gear. As a lucky coincidence, I met and started climbing with the now-legendary Steve Petro who told me I was too fat and weak to be a good climber. "What you should do," he said, "is 100 pull-ups a day." And there began my first training program. Slowly I got stronger and leaner and better at climbing.

My interest in improving my climbing continued to develop over the years, including majoring in exercise science in college and relentlessly pursuing every bit of information I could find on training for strength and conditioning. Some twenty years later, although I felt I'd pretty much figured out how to train for hard climbing, I ran across a document online called "The Making of a Rock Prodigy." It was a frank and well thought out piece about how Mike Anderson had figured out how to stop sucking at climbing.

I emailed him about the document, and Mike and I began a correspondence about training for climbing, then about big wall climbing, and eventually we became somewhat regular climbing partners.

Not much later, Mike introduced me to his brother, Mark. Mark was making regular trips to the crags near my home in Lander, and our families became fast friends. Within a few visits, I could see that Mark was every bit as serious and knowledgeable about training as his brother. In fact, Mike once told me that "Mark knows just as much about training as I do, he just applies it better." That was maybe five years ago.

Over the course of many discussions, I came to see that the Rock Prodigy plan was a living document, refined two or three times a year and discussed exhaustively between the brothers. What I saw with my own eyes was that the training program worked - not a normal attribute of many training programs.

Most climbers see a fairly steep improvement curve the first few months or couple of years that they climb. After a while, though, they plateau and then spend the rest of their career getting in and out of shape for the same old grade, never again advancing to harder routes. What fascinated me about the brothers is that both of them continued to crawl their way up the grades each year. Both Mike and Mark work full time, have families, and climb 5.14 regularly. The crazy thing is that they're still getting better!

The book you now hold in your hands is the result of years spent designing and testing training plans. It is the result of many near-misses and many successes at the crags, on big walls, and in the mountains. Never before have I met athletes as dedicated to honest self-reflection and improvement. Never before have I met climbers able to morph their vast knowledge into a useable and clear program that can be scaled to multiple performance levels.

I write articles on training for climbing, I coach climbers, and I still try to climb harder than I did when I was thirty. Over the past few years, the Anderson brothers have become my go-to B.S. detector when it comes to any fringe training ideas. They have become great advisors on redpointing hard climbs. They have become my coaches, my most valuable resource, and now they can be yours, too. Read the book, do what the book tells you to do, and you'll start creeping up the grades again.

The Rock Climber's Training Manual is an important step forward in the practice of improved climbing. The rigorous and carefully planned programs in these pages might seem too boring or restrictive compared to the "training" you normally do. But as the brothers say, "Climbing hard routes is never boring."

Steve Bechtel
Certified Strength and Conditioning Specialist
www.climbstrong.com



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